

UNOFFICIAL FAN GUIDE

2026 SEASON GUIDE

Teams, Drivers & Key Storylines

A Beginner's Guide to the Formula 1 Season

2026 Full Grid

The 2026 season features 11 teams and 22 drivers - the first time F1 has had more than 10 teams since 2016. Cadillac enters as the newest constructor.

#	Team	PU	Driver 1	Driver 2
1	Red Bull Racing	Ford	Max Verstappen	Isack Hadjar
2	Ferrari	Ferrari	Lewis Hamilton	Charles Leclerc
3	McLaren	Mercedes	Lando Norris	Oscar Piastri
4	Mercedes	Mercedes	George Russell	Kimi Antonelli
5	Aston Martin	Honda	Fernando Alonso	Lance Stroll
6	Alpine	Mercedes	Pierre Gasly	Franco Colapinto
7	Williams	Mercedes	Carlos Sainz	Alexander Albon
8	Racing Bulls	Ford	Liam Lawson	Arvid Lindblad
9	Haas	Ferrari	Esteban Ocon	Oliver Bearman
10	Sauber (Audi)	Audi	Nico Hulkenberg	Gabriel Bortoleto
11	Cadillac	Ferrari	Valtteri Bottas	Sergio Perez

11

Teams

22

Drivers

1

Rookie

5

Sophomores

Team Profiles

Red Bull Racing

Base: Milton Keynes, UK | Principal: Christian Horner | PU: Ford

Max Verstappen (NED) / Isack Hadjar (FRA)

Back-to-back constructors' champions (2022-2023), Red Bull enter 2026 with Max Verstappen hungry for redemption after narrowly losing the 2025 title to Lando Norris by just 2 points. Despite a remarkable late-season surge, Verstappen fell agonizingly short. The four-time world champion (2021-2024) is determined to reclaim the championship under the radical new regulations. Isack Hadjar, the 2024 F2 runner-up, steps up after a strong rookie season at Racing Bulls in 2025 (51 points, including a podium).

Scuderia Ferrari

Base: Maranello, Italy | Principal: Fred Vasseur | PU: Ferrari

Lewis Hamilton (GBR) / Charles Leclerc (MON)

Lewis Hamilton enters his second year at Ferrari, determined to prove his difficult 2025 season was an anomaly. In his first year at the Scuderia, Hamilton finished 6th in the standings with zero Grand Prix podiums, scoring 86 points fewer than teammate Charles Leclerc. The seven-time world champion will be eager to show that the new 2026 regulations can reset his fortunes. Leclerc, who comprehensively outperformed Hamilton in 2025, looks to build on that momentum and challenge for the title.

McLaren F1 Team

Base: Woking, UK | Principal: Andrea Stella | PU: Mercedes

Lando Norris (GBR) / Oscar Piastri (AUS)

The reigning double champions enter 2026 as the team to beat. Lando Norris won the 2025 World Drivers' Championship - his first title - in a dramatic finale, beating Verstappen by just 2 points. McLaren also secured back-to-back Constructors' Championships (2024-2025). Oscar Piastri finished 3rd in the 2025 standings, confirming his status as a top-tier talent. Can Norris and McLaren three-peat under the radical new regulations?

Mercedes-AMG Petronas

Base: Brackley, UK | Principal: Toto Wolff | PU: Mercedes

George Russell (GBR) / Kimi Antonelli (ITA)

Post-Hamilton Mercedes rebuilds around George Russell and Kimi Antonelli, now entering his second season after a promising debut year in 2025. The team's power unit is supplied to four teams total (McLaren, Alpine, Williams), giving Mercedes significant engine development leverage.

Aston Martin Aramco

Base: Silverstone, UK | Principal: Adrian Newey | PU: Honda

Fernando Alonso (ESP) / Lance Stroll (CAN)

Fernando Alonso, now 44, continues to defy age in what could be one of his final seasons. Adrian Newey's arrival as team principal brings the legendary designer's expertise to Aston Martin's ambitious project. The new Silverstone campus and Honda power unit supply make this a pivotal year for the team's long-term ambitions under Lawrence Stroll's ownership.

Alpine F1 Team

Base: Enstone, UK / Viry, France | Principal: Flavio Briatore (Exec. Advisor) | PU: Mercedes

Pierre Gasly (FRA) / Franco Colapinto (ARG)

Alpine's biggest change: dropping their in-house Renault engine for Mercedes power. Pierre Gasly leads the team alongside Franco Colapinto, now in his second season after replacing Jack Doohan early in 2025 and impressing with his speed. The team aims for a fresh start with new leadership.

Williams Racing

Base: Grove, UK | Principal: James Vowles | PU: Mercedes

Carlos Sainz (ESP) / Alexander Albon (THA)

Carlos Sainz's arrival from Ferrari gives Williams their most experienced driver lineup in years. Paired with the consistent Alex Albon, the team looks to capitalize on the regulation reset to return to midfield competitiveness under James Vowles' leadership.

Visa Cash App Racing Bulls

Base: Faenza, Italy | Principal: Laurent Mekies | PU: Ford

Liam Lawson (NZL) / Arvid Lindblad (GBR)

Liam Lawson takes on the team leader role after a turbulent 2025 that saw him promoted to Red Bull mid-season, then reassigned for 2026. British teenage talent Arvid Lindblad is the grid's only true rookie, graduating from the Red Bull junior program. At just 18, Lindblad is one of the youngest drivers in F1 history.

MoneyGram Haas F1 Team

Base: Kannapolis, USA / Maranello, Italy | Principal: Ayao Komatsu | PU: Ferrari

Esteban Ocon (FRA) / Oliver Bearman (GBR)

Haas continues its rebuilding phase with Esteban Ocon joining from Alpine and Oliver Bearman in his second full season after scoring 41 points as a rookie in 2025. The Ferrari power unit and closer technical ties give Haas reason for optimism.

Sauber / Audi F1 Team

Base: Hinwil, Switzerland | Principal: Mattia Binotto | PU: Audi

Nico Hulkenberg (GER) / Gabriel Bortoleto (BRA)

2026 marks the full Audi takeover, with the German manufacturer supplying their own power unit for the first time. Mattia Binotto leads the project, with Nico Hulkenberg providing experience and Gabriel Bortoleto entering his second season after a solid rookie year at Sauber in 2025. The Audi PU is the great unknown of the new regulations.

Cadillac F1 Team

Base: Fishers, Indiana, USA | Principal: Graeme Lowdon | PU: Ferrari (customer)

Valtteri Bottas (FIN) / Sergio Perez (MEX)

Formula 1's 11th team and the first new constructor since Haas in 2016. Backed by General Motors, Cadillac enters with a Ferrari customer power unit while developing their own GM engine for the future. Valtteri Bottas brings valuable experience, while Sergio Perez adds massive know-how as a former race winner and longtime Red Bull driver. Under team principal Graeme Lowdon, the team aims to establish itself quickly.

Rising Stars

The 2026 grid features one true rookie and five exciting second-year drivers making their mark in the sport.

Driver	Nat.	Team	Notes
Arvid Lindblad	GBR	Racing Bulls	The grid's ONLY rookie. 18 years old; one of the youngest F1 drivers ever.
Isack Hadjar	FRA	Red Bull Racing	Second year. Strong 2025 at Racing Bulls (51 pts, podium). 2024 F2 runner-up.
Kimi Antonelli	ITA	Mercedes	Second year. Italian prodigy in his sophomore Mercedes season.
Oliver Bearman	GBR	Haas	Second year. Scored 41 points as a Haas rookie in 2025.
Gabriel Bortoleto	BRA	Sauber / Audi	Second year. 2024 F2 Champion; solid debut season at Sauber.
Franco Colapinto	ARG	Alpine	Second year. Replaced Doohan mid-2025 at Alpine; impressed with speed.

Key Storylines for 2026

Norris Defends His Crown

Lando Norris won the 2025 World Drivers' Championship by just 2 points over Max Verstappen in one of the most dramatic title fights in recent memory. Can he and McLaren three-peat as both Drivers' and Constructors' Champions? The regulation revolution will test whether their dominance can survive a complete rule reset.

Verstappen's Redemption

Max Verstappen lost his title in 2025 after a remarkable late-season charge - but it wasn't enough, falling 2 points short. The four-time champion (2021-2024) enters 2026 with a rage-fueled determination to reclaim what he considers his. New regulations could either help or hinder Red Bull's cause.

Hamilton's Second Chance at Ferrari

Lewis Hamilton's first season at Ferrari in 2025 was the worst of his career: 6th in the standings, zero Grand Prix podiums,

and 86 points behind teammate Leclerc. The seven-time champion enters 2026 viewing the regulation reset as his opportunity to prove 2025 was an aberration, not a decline. All eyes are on whether Hamilton can recapture his magic.

The Regulation Revolution

The 2026 regulations are the biggest overhaul in over a decade. New power units, active aerodynamics, sustainable fuels, and smaller cars create a level playing field. Every team starts from scratch, making this the most unpredictable season in years. New entrants Audi and Cadillac have a unique opportunity to be competitive from day one.

Season Preview

The 2026 season promises to be one of the most exciting in F1 history. With the biggest regulation change in a decade, defending champion Norris, a vengeful Verstappen, Hamilton seeking redemption at Ferrari, a new manufacturer (Audi), a new team (Cadillac), and one of the youngest rookies in F1 history in Lindblad, every race weekend will offer drama.